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Do not
write
anything in
this margin(c) Discuss the various magico-religious functionaries in human societies

Magico-religious functionaries are special persons concerned with conducting magic and religion in human societies.

between nature & supernatural

Frazer in his book 'The Golden Bough (1928)' defined magic as an activity towards a specific aim to compel supernatural.

Durkheim defined religion as the unified system of beliefs and symbols that is relative to sacred things.

Various magico-religious functionaries

1) Priests

- These are the persons who perform various religious activities in the society.
- ∴ They have important role to play in marriage and rites de passage

3) They are highly respected in the society

For eg: Prof Vidyaarthy in his work 'The Sacred Complex (1960)' talked about priests who performed mahayagna in sacred complex of Gaya.

2) Shamanism

a) They are also known as the medicine man.

b) They are known to have contacts with spirits who in turn guide them to heal a person.

c) They have prime importance during wars between different tribal groups.

d) They are also a connection ~~to~~ between tribe members and spirits.

Define by
any thinker
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3) Witchcraft & sorcery

a) They are responsible for doing black magic in the societies.

b) They are often feared and they can cause ill health.

c) There are also issues like blaming a woman as witch and killing her in many tribal societies.

any specific
examples

Impact on magico
religious functionaries

modern laws like IPC,
CrPC

modern health facilities

penetration of science
in tribal areas.

Magico-religious functionaries play an important role in social order in simple societies. However, they have been impacted by forces of globalization & colonialism.